Incident Escalation SOP

Restricted: managers and administrators. This SOP explains how to classify and escalate service incidents.

1 Severity levels

Sev 1: full outage of a client-facing service, or a suspected data breach.

Sev 2: a major feature is unavailable for several clients, with no workaround.

Sev 3: a single client is affected, or a workaround exists.

2 Escalation procedure

1. Log the incident in the service desk with a severity level and a short description.
2. For Sev 1, call the duty manager immediately on the out-of-hours line 0800 555 0199, at any time of day.
3. For Sev 2, notify the duty manager on the incident channel within 30 minutes.
4. The duty manager opens a bridge call and appoints an incident lead.
5. Send a first client update within 1 hour for Sev 1 and within 4 hours for Sev 2, using template INC-UPD.
6. Post updates every hour until the incident is resolved.

3 Suspected data breach

Treat any suspected data breach as Sev 1. Inform the Data Protection Officer within 2 hours. Do not contact affected individuals until the Data Protection Officer approves the message.

4 After the incident

Hold a post-incident review within 5 business days for every Sev 1 and Sev 2 incident. Record root cause, actions and owners in the incident log.